PROactive
ACCENT REDUCTION

# Two Accepted Pronunciations

In English, there are a few words that most people accept as being pronounced in two ways. Each is pronounced slightly differently by various speakers, and each pronunciation is widely accepted.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Basil | /eɪ/ “EH EE” | vs /æ/ “AA” |
| Apricot | /eɪ/ “EH EE” | vs /æ/ “AA” |
| Roof | /u/ “OO” | vs /ʊ/ rhymes with “book” |
| Aunt | /a/ “AH” | vs /æ/ “AA” |
| Process | /a/ “AH” | vs /oʊ/ “OH WW” |
| Direct | /aɪ/ “AH EE” | vs /ə/ “UH” |
| Economic | /i/ “EE” | vs /ɛ/ “EH” |
| Either | /aɪ/ “AH EE” | vs /i/ “EE” |
| Envelope | /a/ “AH” | vs. /ɛ/ “EH” |
| With | /ð/ voiced | vs /θ/ voiceless |